

Medication Safety Policy

Pharmacy Department

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Department: Pharmacy Department

Status: Active

1. Purpose

Establishes safeguards to prevent medication errors across prescribing, dispensing, and administration at Shifa Hospital.

2. The Five Rights of Medication Administration

- Right Patient — verified using two identifiers
- Right Medication — checked against the original order
- Right Dose — calculated and double-checked, especially for pediatric/weight-based dosing
- Right Route — oral, IV, IM, etc., as specified in the order
- Right Time — administered within the approved time window

3. High-Alert Medications

Medications such as insulin, anticoagulants, concentrated electrolytes, and chemotherapy agents require an independent double-check by a second qualified staff member before administration.

4. Allergy & Interaction Checks

The HMS displays an automatic alert if a new prescription conflicts with a documented allergy or an existing medication on the patient's active list. Alerts must be acknowledged with a documented reason before the order can proceed.

5. Adverse Drug Reaction (ADR) Reporting

Any suspected adverse drug reaction is reported immediately to the treating physician and logged in the ADR register within 24 hours, including the medication, dose, reaction observed, and action taken.

6. Look-Alike / Sound-Alike (LASA) Medications

LASA medications are stored in separate, clearly labeled locations and flagged with warning stickers to reduce the risk of selection errors during dispensing.

7. Staff Training

All clinical staff involved in medication handling complete annual medication safety training and competency assessment.